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Most workgroups and departments consisting of 25 people or thereabouts generally use a laser-based MFD solution. This is not only because a laser-based MFD is far cheaper courtesy the laser printing functionality, but it's also faster. And that leads to improved productivity.

Some models of laser-based MFDs have special features that remain largely unused, since most users are unaware of them. Here's looking at some of these features to help you get the most out of your MFD.

Copying

The copy button is one of the most-used buttons on the MFD. Generally, copying is done at default or preset settings. However, in some models, you can tweak this. Here's a small list of such tweaks.

Autofit Copying

This is a copying mode that works when you manually place the document on the glass and not on the Automatic Document Feeder (ADF). Next, you can press the 'Special' button on the MFD and then, using the 'Scroll' button, locate the 'Autofit' option.

Pressing 'Enter' will save the selection, and you can start the copying process. This is especially useful in scenarios where you need to spread a small amount of data over a page. This gives the page a professional appeal.

Clone Copying

Clone Copying is another technique that spreads a small amount of data over the whole page, and instead of just spreading the data, it creates

identical copies of the data on the same page. For instance, if you want four copies of a receipt—by using the Clone Copy option, you can fit this on one page, and cut the page to get the four copies.

Again, this mode works only when you manually place the document on the glass, and not in the ADF. You can do so in the same manner as mentioned above in Autofit copying, but instead of looking for 'Autofit' when you access the menu, choose the 'Clone' option.

Collation Copying

Collation Copying is an extremely useful feature. In this process, you can get a set of documents collated and sorted automatically as per your needs.



Control panel of a laser-based MFD

For instance, if you want to copy a five-page document, sort the pages in a manner in which they have to be copied, place them in the ADF, and then press the 'Special' button. Next, access the menu, go to the 'Collation' option. Then press 'Enter' to choose that menu, and start the copying process to get accurately sorted sets of the number of copies you had specified.

Two-Sided Copying

This option is present on some MFDs. It's useful for copying information from smaller sheets

of paper and showing them on the same page.

Consider business cards that have printed data on both sides. A card can be kept on the glass document scanner, and both sides of the card can be copied onto a single sheet of paper on one side.

In order to get to this menu, follow the same path as given above for 'Autofit Copying'. All you need to do is look for the '2-Side' option in the menu. Then press 'Enter' and start copying.

2-Up Or 4-Up Copying

This is another useful mode, if you want to compare two documents, or want a copy of two different documents on the same page. You can also choose to have four documents fitted onto a single sheet of A4-sized paper—good enough for comparing four documents on a single sheet.

There will be a reduction in the size of the printed text when you choose this mode. This mode can only be accessed when you are manually copying documents, and not using the ADF.

Poster Copying

This is a special mode that lets you expand a single document to a poster. Poster copying is only possible when you are manually copying a document. It's a good technique for blowing up a single image on one page to multiple pages. Choose the 'Poster' option from the menu and start copying.

Faxing

Faxing is available on most laser-based MFD models. Generally, you can use the MFD to receive faxes using the preset settings.

However, if you are worried about confidential faxes falling into wrong hands, you can configure the MFD to not

PRINT. SCAN. COPY.
With any laser printer.